

Low-Dose Naltrexone (LDN) for Chronic Pain & EDS

LDN (Low-Dose Naltrexone) is an off-label, low-dose use of a medication originally approved to treat opioid and alcohol addiction. In smaller doses (0.1–6.0 mg/day), it may help reduce inflammation, modulate the immune system, and decrease pain—especially in conditions like **Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome** and chronic musculoskeletal pain.

Why I Prescribe It:

For patients with EDS, HSD, MCAS, POTS, and ME/CFS, pain is often widespread, complex, and frustrating to manage.

In my clinical experience, LDN can be a helpful part of a multimodal strategy — not a magic bullet, but a meaningful tool.

LDN Benefits:

- **Reduced musculoskeletal and neuropathic pain**
- **Improved sleep quality and less post-exertional malaise**
- **Greater emotional resilience and autonomic balance**
- **Mast cell stabilization and improved tolerance of triggers**
- **Modulation of the immune system in patients with chronic inflammation**

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Conditions where LDN is commonly used or studied:

- **Neurological and Pain Disorders:** Fibromyalgia, complex regional pain syndrome, multiple sclerosis, migraine, and others.
- **Autoimmune Diseases:** Hashimoto's thyroiditis, rheumatoid arthritis, systemic lupus erythematosus, psoriasis, and more.
- **Chronic Inflammatory Conditions:** ME/CFS, Long COVID, mast cell activation syndrome, interstitial cystitis, and pelvic pain syndromes.
- **Mental Health and Neuropsychiatric Conditions:** Depression, PTSD, anxiety disorders, and autism spectrum disorders with autoimmune or GI symptoms.
- **Gastrointestinal and Metabolic Conditions:** IBS, SIBO, celiac disease, nonalcoholic fatty liver disease, and diabetes.
- **Oncology:** Used adjunctively in breast, colorectal, pancreatic cancers, and glioblastoma to improve immune surveillance and potentially reduce side effects.

Mechanistically, LDN works by temporarily blocking opioid receptors, leading to a rebound increase in endorphins. It also inhibits Toll-Like Receptor 4 (TLR4), reducing glial activation and neuroinflammation, and modulates immune function to promote balance without causing full immunosuppression.

Medical Advice Disclaimer

This information is purely educational and does not intend to be a substitute for personalized medical advice. Always consult with your doctor to determine what tests and treatment are right for you.



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